ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 1: **A Letter to God (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** dramatic irony	A wish granted in a harmful way.
2	**(b)** The ingratitude is the source of irony and shows human flaws	Defence of authorial choice.
3	**(c)** gullible	Gullible.
4	**(b)** Lencho trusts the unseen God but doubts the people who actually help	Core paradox.
5	**(b)** justify Lencho's desperation	It earns sympathy.
6	**(c)** too trusting	Too trusting.
7	**(b)** Ethically gentle: a small untruth done for a larger good	Intent matters.
8	**(c)** traits are proven by deeds	Showing versus telling.
9	**(b)** a sudden sharp feeling of sympathy	Pang = a sudden sharp feeling.
10	**(c)** His faith might be hurt, though he would also realise human kindness	Inference.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It stresses the ripe corn and Lencho's hope for rain (1) so that the loss feels larger by contrast (1).	1+1
12	To preserve Lencho's faith (1) and to give the story its ironic end (1).	1+1
13	He acts selflessly (1) and keeps another's hope alive without credit (1).	1+1
14	His laughter is at the oddity, not cruelty (1), and it quickly changes to concern, proving he is humane (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Strength: it gives hope after ruin (1). Weakness: it makes him expect help without question (1). It causes him to misjudge the people who help (1).	1+1+1
16	The postmaster's act is central (1). The readers admire him (1). The story gently asks us to help without asking for thanks (1).	1+1+1
17	Although he lost his crop, Lencho kept his faith (1). He lost his crop but he kept his faith (1). Complex has a dependent clause, compound has coordinated clauses (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He lied by signing as God (1). The aim was to protect faith and help a needy man (1). Hence the deception is gentle and defensible (1).	1+1+1
18	Lencho's faith is sincere but passive (1). Kindness is active (1). Hence kindness is more admirable, while faith motivates it (1).	1+1+1
	OR: If Lencho had known the truth, he would not have blamed the clerks (1). Third conditional used for unreal past (1). Verb forms: had known / would not have blamed (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Lencho is the protagonist who suffers (1). The postmaster takes the decisions and acts (1). His kindness drives the plot (1). Lencho's faith inspires but the postmaster delivers (1). Conclusion: both essential, the postmaster is the moral hero (1).	2+2+1
	OR: He acted promptly (1). He used his salary and friends (1). He could have sent more or explained (1). But then the faith would be shaken (1). Judgement: his choice is wise given the situation (1).	2+2+1
20	Faith as Lencho's strength (1). Suspicion of human beings (1). Kindness in the postmaster (1). Irony linking them (1). The message that goodness works quietly (1).	2+2+1

	OR: Greeting and stand (1). Lencho's faith could not feed his family (1). Help came through action (1). Faith and effort should combine (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Lencho *asked for 100 pesos and the postmaster sent 100*; the postmaster could collect only about 70 pesos, which is why Lencho later complains.
- Saying Lencho lost faith in God; his faith in God stays unshaken. He doubts only the **post-office employees**, calling them a 'bunch of crooks'.
- Mixing up the weather images: the raindrops were like *new coins* (a simile), and the hail did more damage than a plague of locusts; do not call both 'hail like coins'.
- Ignoring the **irony** in the ending: the man who trusts God completely is the one who suspects honest people; the postmaster's kindness is exactly what Lencho fails to see.
- Writing that the postmaster ignored the letter; he first laughed, then was moved, and wrote a reply signed **'God'** to keep Lencho's faith alive.
- Spelling slips: *Lencho, postmaster, hailstorm, plague of locusts*; and using 'who' for things (the letter *which*, not who).

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 1: **A Letter to God (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** gentle and ironic	Tone.
2	**(a)** inadequate	He wanted to help fully.
3	**(c)** wants readers to reflect on the irony	Open irony.
4	**(b)** The postmaster admired Lencho's honest faith	Inference needs the reader's interpretation.
5	**(b)** assumption	Not supported by evidence.
6	**(c)** They can be vehicles for human kindness	Personal compassion within an institution.
7	**(a)** Neither Lencho nor his sons were hungry.	Verb agrees with the nearer subject (sons).
8	**(c)** Faith, Irony and Human Kindness	Fits all themes.
9	**(d)** letters and money	From hopeful letter to angry one.
10	**(c)** In spite of being poor, Lencho was proud of his faith.	'In spite of' + gerund.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It shows faith as a source of strength (1) while also showing its blind side in Lencho's reaction (1).	1+1
12	Lencho learns the truth and thanks the postmaster (1); the theme becomes gratitude and the irony is lost (1).	1+1
13	It shows he plans practically (1) and gives him a standard against which he judges the shortfall (1).	1+1
14	It contrasts hope and ruin (1) and faith in God against mistrust of men (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	We saw his total loss (1). We know his innocence (1). So his anger seems human rather than wicked (1).	1+1+1
16	We would feel his dilemma (1). The humour would be his own amusement and worry (1). Lencho's anger would hurt more (1).	1+1+1
17	Lencho kept faith in God despite the hail (1). He did not lose heart even when the crop was ruined (1). Meanings: remain loyal / become discouraged (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It reverses expectations (1). It reveals character without comment (1). It leaves readers amused and thoughtful (1).	1+1+1
18	Comic: Lencho's absurd complaint (1). Sad: the postmaster's kindness is unthanked (1). Overall it is tragicomic (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It is a strong word of accusation (1). It shows emotion overtook reason (1). It also shows his poor judgement of people (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Beginning: hopeful, looking at the sky (1). Hail: despair but not defeat (1). Writing letter: faith in action (1). End: anger, ungrateful (1). Overall: constant faith, limited vision (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Contrast: hope vs ruin (1). Irony: helped but accuses (1). Humour: letter to God, postmaster's laugh (1). They keep the tone light yet moving (1). Message: kindness and faith in an imperfect world (1).	2+2+1
20	Introduction (1). Lencho's belief in God (1). Effects of belief in crisis (1). Possible dangers of unthinking belief (1). Conclusion with personal view (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Opening setting and character (1). A problem arises (1). Helper steps in (1). Resolution (1). Moral or closing line (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Lencho *asked for 100 pesos and the postmaster sent 100*; the postmaster could collect only about 70 pesos, which is why Lencho later complains.

- Saying Lencho lost faith in God; his faith in God stays unshaken. He doubts only the **post-office employees**, calling them a 'bunch of crooks'.
- Mixing up the weather images: the raindrops were like *new coins* (a simile), and the hail did more damage than a plague of locusts; do not call both 'hail like coins'.
- Ignoring the **irony** in the ending: the man who trusts God completely is the one who suspects honest people; the postmaster's kindness is exactly what Lencho fails to see.
- Writing that the postmaster ignored the letter; he first laughed, then was moved, and wrote a reply signed **'God'** to keep Lencho's faith alive.
- Spelling slips: *Lencho, postmaster, hailstorm, plague of locusts*; and using 'who' for things (the letter *which*, not who).

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 1: **A Letter to God (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** dramatic irony	We know the postmaster's role; Lencho does not.
2	**(c)** Faith and goodness exist side by side with misunderstanding	Theme summary.
3	**(b)** If the hail had not come, Lencho would have harvested the corn.	Third conditional.
4	**(d)** universality of the farmer's plight	It could be any rural place.
5	**(c)** he blames the staff without evidence	Faulty reasoning.
6	**(a)** When the postmaster read the letter, he laughed.	Subordinate clause with 'when'.
7	**(a)** His misfortune is sad while his ingratitude is comic	Tone.
8	**(b)** He sensibly requested an exact sum for a definite need	Practical planning.
9	**(b)** are, believe	Should be 'is' and 'believes'.
10	**(a)** indifference replacing compassion	Counterfactual.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	A remote farm shows helplessness before nature (1) and makes faith the only support (1).	1+1
12	It is unfair since the staff helped (1) but understandable from his unquestioning faith (1).	1+1
13	It adds humour and irony (1) and leaves readers reflecting on human ingratitude (1).	1+1
14	Unreliable: based on assumption and not evidence (1); his faith blinds him to the reality (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Rain stands for hope and wealth (1). Hail for sudden ruin (1). Together they show nature's dual power over the farmer (1).	1+1+1
16	Anonymous characters represent types (1). Makes the story universal (1). Draws attention to the human values involved (1).	1+1+1
17	Many farmers still depend on weather (1). Faith and charity still matter (1). People are still quick to blame (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The postmaster's fat amiable look (1). Lencho's habit of looking at the sky (1). The envelope with stamp (1).	1+1+1
18	God will answer by mail (1). The clerks must have kept the rest (1). Both are untested; the second is false since the postmaster gave all he could (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He lost his crop and the family's future (1). His faith is sincere (1). His ingratitude is a human fault, not malice, so he does deserve sympathy (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Format (1). Apology for the harsh words (1). Gratitude for the help (1). Reflection on faith and kindness (1). Courteous close (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Farmers depend on weather (1). One storm ends a year's work (1). They have no safety net (1). Hope and community help are their support (1). Conclusion: the story tells of a struggle against nature (1).	2+2+1
20	It reveals human weakness (1). It preserves irony (1). It gives a moral that goes beyond happy endings (1). It leaves readers to think (1). It shows realistic characters (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format with questions and answers (1). Why he laughed at first (1). Why he helped (1). What he thinks of Lencho (1). His message to readers (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Lencho *asked for 100 pesos and the postmaster sent 100*; the postmaster could collect only about 70 pesos, which is why Lencho later complains.
- Saying Lencho lost faith in God; his faith in God stays unshaken. He doubts only the **post-office employees**, calling them a 'bunch of crooks'.
- Mixing up the weather images: the raindrops were like *new coins* (a simile), and the hail did more damage than a plague of locusts; do not call both 'hail like coins'.
- Ignoring the **irony** in the ending: the man who trusts God completely is the one who suspects honest people; the postmaster's kindness is exactly what Lencho fails to see.
- Writing that the postmaster ignored the letter; he first laughed, then was moved, and wrote a reply signed **'God'** to keep Lencho's faith alive.
- Spelling slips: *Lencho, postmaster, hailstorm, plague of locusts*; and using 'who' for things (the letter *which*, not who).

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND